NO. 2
JANUARY 2027

GUIDED CHILDHOOD NEWS

AGES 6 TO 11
PRINT, READ, DO

The Guided Times

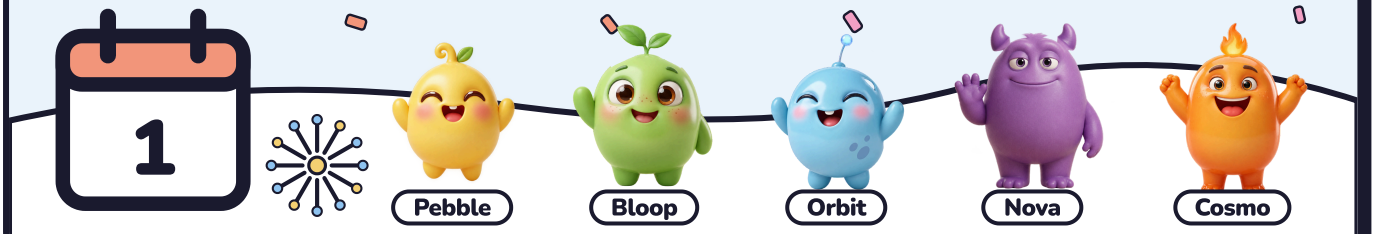
Happy news for growing up with screens

FRONT PAGE NEWS

New Year, New Deal!

Happy New Year!

The Planet Friends are writing screen deals with their families this month. Here is how yours can too.



A screen deal is a short list your whole family agrees: when screens are on, where they sleep, and what happens when time is up. No arguing every night, because the deal already says.

Turn to page 3 to write yours in six steps, then pin it up with the poster in the middle of this paper. Your grown up gets a star bit too.

IN THIS ISSUE

Write your screen deal 3
Seven phone free dinners 4
The big question 5
Pull out poster 7
Puzzles and jokes 10

Wow!

WOW FACT

January is named after Janus, a Roman god with two faces: one looks back at the old year and one looks forward to the new.

FREE TASTER 3 of 12 pages · more free printables at guidedchildhood.com/free
guidedchildhood.com/free/guided-times-2

A LETTER FROM THE EDITOR

Happy New Year, and welcome to Issue 2!



This month is all about fresh starts. The Planet Friends are writing screen deals with their families: short, fair lists that everyone agrees. Yours can too, with the poster in the middle of this paper.

There is a challenge to try, a big question to vote on, and puzzles and jokes at the back. The bits for grown ups are marked with a star.

Happy New Year, DiGi

News in brief

FROM AROUND THE PLANET



Pebble's family counts birds

Pebble's family spent one hour by the window counting garden birds. Pebble saw a robin and drew it for the fridge.



Bloop's tablet gets a parking spot

Bloop made a sign for the kitchen shelf where the tablet sleeps. Make your own sign on page 11.



Orbit's password rule

Orbit's grown up says a password is like a toothbrush: you never share it. Orbit agrees, and keeps it secret.



Cosmo tries phone free dinners

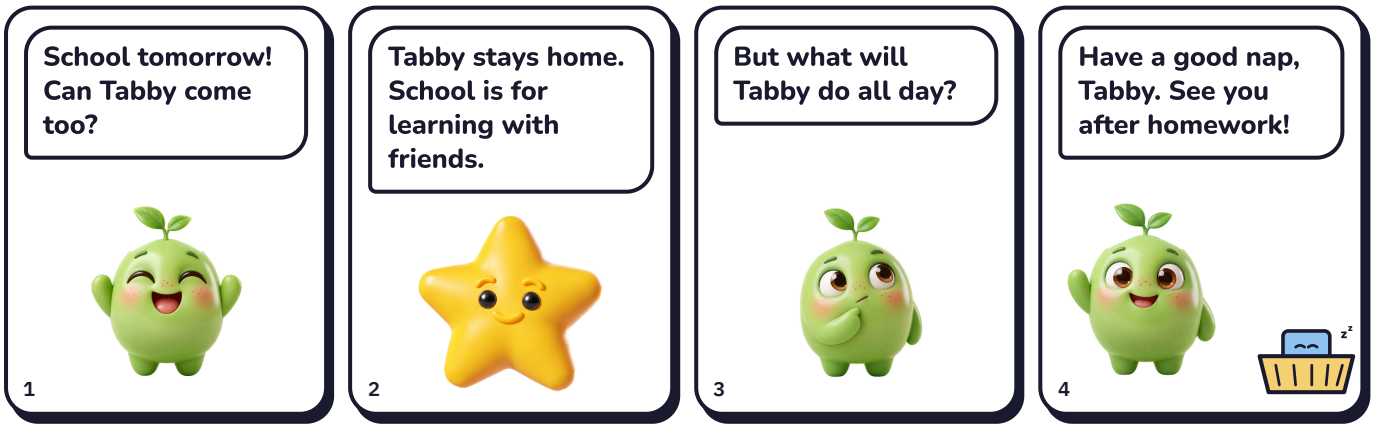
Cosmo parked a phone for a whole week of dinners. Cosmo says the best bit was the silly table talk. Try it on page 4.

? DID YOU KNOW?
The RSPB's Big Garden Birdwatch began in 1979. Every January, families count the birds they see in one hour.

? DID YOU KNOW?
The first website ever went online in 1991. You can still visit it today.

Tabby goes back to school

THE COMIC STRIP, PART 2 TO BE CONTINUED



FREE TASTER 3 of 12 pages · more free printables at guidedchildhood.com/free guidedchildhood.com/free/guided-times-2

The big feature

Write your family's screen deal

A screen deal is a short list your whole family agrees. Write it together in the first week of January, then pin it up on the poster on page 7.

1 Look back at Christmas

What went well with screens, and what was tricky? Everyone says one of each.

2 Choose protected times

Times with no screens at all, for everyone. Meals and bedtime are good ones to start with.

3 Agree earned time

Which jobs earn stars, and how many minutes a star is worth in your house.

4 Pick where screens sleep

One spot in a shared room where every screen charges overnight.

5 Plan the stop

Decide together what happens when time is up, so it is never a surprise.

6 Sign it and pin it up

Everyone signs the poster on page 7. Check it again at half term.



Pick a calm evening
The first week of January

→



Talk it through
About twenty minutes

→



Write it on the poster
Page 7

→



Check it at half term
In February



★ FOR GROWN UPS

Keep it short, and use your child's words where you can. Ask what they think is fair before you say what you think. If a line is not working, change it together at half term, never in the middle of a row.

FREE TASTER 3 of 12 pages · more free printables at guidedchildhood.com/free guidedchildhood.com/free/guided-times-2